Hasti Darabipourshiraz

Fourth-year PhD Student, Designer, and Researcher in Computer Science with a focus on Human-Computer Interaction at Northwestern University.

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University, Evanston, Illinois — *PhD*
September 2023 - Anticipated Graduation Date: June 2028
Department of Computer Science and Communication Studies, Creative Interfaces Research and Design Lab.

Northwestern University, Evanston, Illinois — *Masters*
September 2023 - March 2025
Department of Computer Science and Communication Studies, Creative Interfaces Research and Design Lab.

Azad University of Kerman, Kerman, Iran — B.SC.
September 2019 - July 2023
Computer Software Engineering.

PUBLICATIONS

DataBites: An embodied and co-creative museum exhibit to foster children's understanding of supervised machine learning.
Hasti Darabipourshiraz, Dev Ambani, and Duri Long. **2024**. In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Creativity & Cognition (C&C'24). https://doi.org/10.1145/3635636.3664247

Introducing AI Without Computers: Hands-On Literacy and Ethical Sense-Making for Young Learners.
Hasti Darabipourshiraz, Maalvika Bhat, and Duri Long. **2025**. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2025). https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3719876

Al DoodleLab: Fostering Middle School Students' Al Literacy through Project-Based Creative Drawing.
Hasti Darabipourshiraz. **2025**. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Creativity & Cognition (C&C'25). https://doi.org/10.1145/3698061.3734417

Al Unplugged: Tangible Simulations of Al Reasoning Processes for Middle School Learners
Hasti Darabipourshiraz, Lily NG, Grace Wang, Sophie Rollins, and Duri Long. **2026**. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Transactions on Computing Education (TOCE) Journal, Special Issue on Embodiment in Computing Education. http://dx.doi.org/10.1145/3786761.

Designing and Evaluating Museum Exhibit Prototypes to Foster Middle Schoolers' AI Literacy through Creativity & Embodiment.
Hasti Darabipourshiraz, Sophie Rollins, Milka Trajkova, Chengzhi Zhang, Yasmine Belghith, Tom McKlin, Jessica Roberts, Brian Magerko, Duri Long. **2026**. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Tangible and Embedded Interaction (TEI '26). https://doi.org/10.1145/3731459.3773305.

Bias Viz: A Project-Based, Narrative-Centered Learning Tool for Engaging Middle Schoolers in Critical Thinking about Al Biases.
Hasti Darabipourshiraz, Shiyan Jiang, Dongkuan Xu, and Duri Long. **2026**. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2026). https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791555.

From Prompt to Process: Supporting Creative Processes and Agency through Traceable Component-Based AI Image Generation
Hasti Darabipourshiraz and Duri Long. **2026**. Submitted to the 2027 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2027).

PROJECTS

TraceFlow: A Process-Oriented and Traceable AI Image Generation System *April 2026 - Present*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

Piece by Piece: A Component-Based AI Image Generation Interface *January 2026 - Present*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

AI DoodleLab: A tool for drawing with AI while learning AI concepts. *March 2025 - Present*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

DataBites: A museum exhibit to teach kids about supervised machine learning. *September 2023 - Present*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

BiasViz: An interactive web-app for young learners to analyse bias in LLMs. March 2023 - *December 2025*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

AI Unplugged: No-tech activities for teaching AI concepts to Young Learners. *January 2024 - December 2025*
Research advisor: Duri Long, Assistant Professor, Northwestern University.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Keyhan Language School English Institute, Website and Social Media Manager Kerman, Iran
November 2021 - August 2023

Kerman Language House English Institute, Website and Social Media Manager Kerman, Iran
June 2019 - August 2023

iTech Digital marketing agency, Website and Social Media Manager Kerman, Iran
July 2021 - September 2022

Key Responsibilities as a Website and Social Media Manager

- Designed and maintained websites prioritizing user experience.
- Created engaging & interactive educational content for websites & social media.
- Led social media accounts management and audience interaction.
- Designed graphics and edited videos to support branding and marketing.

CERTIFICATES

Meta Front-End Developer, May 2024
The front-end developer certificate focuses on front-end development languages and teaches to work with content management systems (CMS).
https://coursera.org/share/bf4c4364de11b4fc405386a33f614a15

AWARDS

Design Cluster Fellowship Recipient, Fall 2024 & Winter 2025
Selected for a prestigious fellowship focused on advancing expertise and innovation in design and interdisciplinary collaboration.

Adobe Fellowship Recipient, Spring 2026
Selected for the Adobe Fellowship in recognition of research demonstrating creativity and innovation in human-AI interaction.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

HTML/ CSS, JavaScript, Flask / React, Python, C++

SOFT SKILLS

Communication, Creativity, Teamwork, Organizational, Leadership, Time Management